CORSAIR'S FORTUNE

Video Slot · 5×3 · 243 Ways · Cannon Hold & Win · Original Concept

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1. Executive Summary

Corsair's Fortune is a pirate-themed 5×3, 243-ways video slot set in the hold of a ship, with a captain who reacts to every spin. Its core is the **Cannon Hold**, a Hold & Win bonus played on four rafts of 3×3 separated by sea lanes. Each raft carries a central multiplier that only switches on when one of the raft's two edges facing the captain is full; filling the facing edges of two rafts lays a plank bridge between them and adds their multipliers together. Linking all four rafts is a **Grand Slam**.

The game is positioned against Pirate Gold (Pragmatic Play), the reference of the genre: an easier-to-read bonus objective, multipliers instead of fixed jackpots, a rare 5-keg **Mega Start** event, and a Scatter Boost and bonus buys that all return 96%.

Format: Single-screen HTML5 game · mobile-first · landscape and portrait layouts
RTP: 96.0% — base game 95.99%, Scatter Boost 96.00%, bonus buys 95.91% / 96.11%
Volatility: High — standard deviation 16.7× the bet per base spin
Hit rate: 42.3% of base spins (1 in 2.4)
Bonus frequency: 1 in 266 spins · 1 in 173 with Scatter Boost
Max win: ×15,000 the bet per spin, reel wins and bonus included (cap)
Bet range: 0.20 € – 100 € (25 steps)
Fairness: every spin and every bonus is fully drawn before its animation starts

2. Core Concept & Theme

2.1 Concept

The player spins five reels in the hold of a pirate ship. Wins pay on 243 ways from the leftmost reel. Powder kegs are the scatters: once two have landed, the remaining reels slow down and the captain holds his breath. Three, four or five kegs pay ×2, ×10 or ×100 and set off a bonus.

In the bonus, the scene moves to the open sea at night. Four rafts of barrels float around a central float where the captain mans a mortar. He fires into the sky and the cannonballs fall on the barrels: every barrel hit can reveal a gold coin, and every coin resets the shot counter to 3. The goal is always visible on the board: fill one of a raft's two edges facing the captain to unlock its multiplier, fill facing edges to bridge two rafts.

2.2 Symbols

Category	Symbols	Role
Low	10, J, Q, K, A	Frequent, small ways wins
High	Hook, Hat, Helm, Chest	Rarer, larger ways wins
Wild	Pirate flag	Reels 2–5 only; substitutes for every paying symbol
Scatter	Powder keg	All reels, at most 1 visible per reel; 3 / 4 / 5 pay ×2 / ×10 / ×100 and trigger a bonus
Bonus only	Gold coins, multiplier medals	Appear on the rafts during the Cannon Hold

2.3 Characters & Presentation

- **The captain** stands beside the reels and reacts to every outcome. His sabre stays in its scabbard except on a near-bonus: when two kegs have landed and a third can still fall, he draws it and stands

en garde. If the bonus triggers, he jumps for joy and his parrot flies up to perch on his tricorne; if it misses, he sobs, wipes his eye and sheathes the sabre. He has 11 moods (idle, watch, point, tense, happy, ecstatic, sad, joy, cry, fire, mortar) with eased transitions; he watches every spin with his hands on his hips and points at the reels on one spin in eight.

- **Captain lines**, in French or English speech bubbles: random lines during spins ("Sail ho!", "Look lively, matey!"), near-bonus lines ("I can smell gunpowder…"), trigger lines ("Fortune, Glory and Power!"), bonus-buy lines ("Excellent choice, matey!"), plus small wins, big wins and bonus events. Most lines come with a spoken pirate exclamation and moving lips (skipped when a previous one is still playing).
- **Base scene:** wooden hold, swinging lanterns, porthole with moonlit sea, gold HUD integrated into the scene.
- **Bonus scene:** night sea in perspective with swell, glints and whitecaps; four rafts moored to a central float; the captain at the mortar, scaled to the sea lane.
- **Big wins:** BIG (×15+), MEGA (×40+), EPIC (×100+), LEGENDARY (×500+), with a count-up and a fanfare.

2.4 Competitive Positioning

	Pirate Gold (Pragmatic)	Corsair's Fortune
Grid	5×4, 40 lines	5×3, 243 ways
RTP	96.5%	96.0%
Volatility	High	High
Respin trigger	8+ money bags	3+ powder kegs (1 in 266)
Top prizes	Minor ×50 / Major ×200 / Grand ×1,000	Raft multipliers ×2–×6, MEGA up to ×40; cap ×15,000
Full-board goal	Grand jackpot on a full grid	Grand Slam: 4 rafts bridged, multipliers summed
Ante bet	No	Scatter Boost +25%, RTP-neutral

2.5 Unique Selling Points

- **A spatial Hold & Win.** The board is a puzzle the player reads at a glance: which raft is one coin away from switching on, which edges could become a bridge.
- **Multipliers that act on screen.** When a raft activates, a golden wave spreads from its medal and every coin it touches changes value. Coins landing later on that raft arrive already multiplied.
- **Bridges instead of jackpots.** Two linked rafts add their multipliers (×5 + ×15 = ×20 on both), which keeps big outcomes possible without a fixed jackpot table.
- **Special shots.** A golden ball pours gold on every coin of a raft, a chain shot raises its multiplier, and a bridge shares the boost across the linked rafts: one more reason to hope for a bridge, and a peak in the middle of the bonus.
- **Mega Start.** Five kegs (1 in 421,399 spins) open the bonus with 4 coins already revealed and a guaranteed MEGA multiplier.
- **Every purchase returns 96%.** Base game, Scatter Boost and both bonus buys are calibrated to the same RTP, which is easy to defend in certification.

3. Game Mechanics

3.1 Base Game Round Flow

- The player sets the bet (25 steps from 0.20 € to 100 €) and spins. The full outcome — reel stops and, if triggered, the whole bonus — is drawn before the reels move.
- Reels stop left to right. When the second powder keg lands before reel 5, the remaining reels slow down one by one (tease) while a heartbeat plays.
- Ways wins are counted and presented one combination at a time (symbol, reel count, ways, amount), then the total counts up in the HUD.
- Wins of ×15 or more open a big-win screen. Three or more kegs pay their scatter prize and start the matching bonus.
- Pressing Space or the spin button during a spin stops the reels at once (slam stop). Three speeds are available: normal, fast (×0.6) and turbo (×0.36).

3.2 243 Ways

A win needs the same symbol on consecutive reels starting from reel 1, on any row. The win per way is multiplied by the number of combinations (symbols counted on each reel, multiplied together). The Wild substitutes on reels 2 to 5 only, so every win is anchored on a real symbol in reel 1.

3.3 Cannon Hold Bonus

- **Intro screen.** Before the first shot, a panel explains the four rules of the bonus (automatic shots, multipliers, bridges, special shots) and the specifics of the bonus type. A click, a tap or Space dismisses it; in autoplay it closes after 2.6 s.
- **Board.** Four 3×3 rafts. The centre of each raft is a multiplier medal; the other 32 cells are barrels. The rafts are separated by sea lanes 1.75 cells wide.
- **Coins.** Coins show their value in euros and their metal tells the size at a glance: bronze below 3× the bet, silver from 3× to 10×, gold above 10×. The metal follows the displayed value, so a coin multiplied by its raft can turn from bronze to silver or gold.
- **Shots.** The captain fires automatically. On each shot, every barrel left has a 5% chance to reveal a coin. A shot that reveals at least one coin resets the counter to 3; a shot that reveals nothing costs one. The bonus ends at 0 or when all 32 cells are filled.
- **Activation.** A raft activates when one of its two edges facing the captain is full: right or bottom edge for the top-left raft, left or bottom for the top-right, right or top for the bottom-left, left or top for the bottom-right. Its multiplier stays hidden behind a « ? » medal until then (a MEGA tag hints at a rare one); on activation it is revealed and applies to all of its coins. A raft that never activates pays its coins at face value, and its multiplier is shown greyed at the end, so the player sees what was missed.
- **Bridges.** When the facing edges of two neighbouring rafts are both full, a plank bridge links them and their multipliers add up; every raft in the group pays the sum. Four rafts linked is a Grand Slam.
- **Special shots.** After each shot, if at least one raft holds coins, a special ball can fall on one of those rafts (chosen at random): a **golden ball** (2.9% per shot) adds a random amount to every coin already on the raft, and a rarer **chain shot** (0.6% per shot) raises the raft's multiplier. If the raft is bridged, the golden ball boosts every coin of the linked rafts, and the chain shot raises the shared multiplier of the group. Special shots never change the shot counter. About 44% of bonuses contain at least one.
- **Resolution.** Each raft sends its coins to the treasure chest at the centre, then the total is paid. The ×15,000 cap applies to the whole spin: the bonus pays at most ×15,000 minus the reel and keg wins of the triggering spin.

3.4 Bonus Types

Bonus	Trigger	Coins (× bet)	Multipliers	Average win
Simple Treasure	3 kegs · 1 in 277 spins	0.5 to 100, average 1.24	×2 to ×4 · MEGA ×8 / ×12 / ×20	×95.91
Incredible Treasure	4 kegs · 1 in 6,834 spins	2 to 100, average 4.10	×3 to ×6 · MEGA ×15 / ×25 / ×40	×480.54
Mega Start	5 kegs · 1 in 421,399 spins	as Incredible, 4 coins pre-revealed	as Incredible + 1 guaranteed MEGA	×784.72

3.5 Scatter Boost & Bonus Buy

- **Scatter Boost (ante bet):** each spin costs 25% more and the bonus lands 1.5 times more often (1 in 173 instead of 1 in 266). RTP 96.00%.
- **Buy Simple Treasure:** 100× the bet, RTP 95.91%. **Buy Incredible Treasure:** 500× the bet, RTP 96.11%.
- Prices are shown at the current bet and confirmed in a dialog before purchase.

3.6 Autoplay

- 10, 25, 50, 100 or 250 spins.
- **Mandatory loss limit** of 20, 50, 100 or 250 bets: autoplay stops before any spin that could take the session loss past the limit.
- Optional stop on a single win above 10, 50 or 100 bets, and optional stop when a bonus triggers.
- Bet, Scatter Boost and bonus buys are locked during autoplay. Opening a menu pauses it; leaving the tab, pressing Space, the spin button or the AUTO button stops it. The remaining spins are shown on the AUTO button.

3.7 Pacing

Moment	Duration (normal speed)
Bonus shot cycle	≈ 2.2 s: counter drops and barrels rattle 0.55 s · ball rises 0.30 s · ball falls 0.45 s · reading pause 0.8 s (0.65 s on a miss)
Target marker	shown on the target barrel from the moment of the shot (growing shadow + red ring)
Multiplier deploy	0.7 s golden wave from the medal across the raft
End of bonus	the 0 stays on screen 0.9 s, then raft-by-raft collection to the chest
Speeds	normal ×1 · fast ×0.6 · turbo ×0.36 applied to most timings

4. Mathematical Model

4.1 Reel Strips

Each reel holds 40 positions. Kegs are spaced so that at most one is visible per reel. The Scatter Boost uses a separate set of strips (640 positions per reel) with 18 to 19 kegs per reel in place of some 10s.

Symbol	R1	R2	R3	R4	R5
10	8	6	6	6	7
J	6	6	5	6	6
Q	5	5	6	5	5

Symbol	R1	R2	R3	R4	R5
K	5	4	5	4	5
A	4	4	4	4	4
Hook	4	3	3	3	4
Hat	3	3	3	3	3
Helm	2	4	3	4	2
Chest	2	2	2	2	2
Wild	0	2	2	2	1
Powder keg	1	1	1	1	1

4.2 Paytable (× bet per way)

Symbol	×3	×4	×5
Wild	substitutes, reels 2–5	—	—
Chest	1.41	4.66	13.99
Helm	0.92	2.80	8.15
Hat	0.47	1.86	4.66
Hook	0.35	1.16	3.49
A	0.23	0.70	2.33
K	0.18	0.58	1.86
Q	0.14	0.47	1.41
J	0.12	0.35	1.16
10	0.10	0.28	0.92

Powder kegs: 3 / 4 / 5 anywhere pay ×2 / ×10 / ×100 the bet and trigger the bonus.

4.3 Bonus Tables

Simple Treasure coin	Weight %	Incredible Treasure coin	Weight %
×0.5	65.3	×2	70.2
×1	21	×5	19
×2	7.5	×10	8
×5	4.3	×25	2.1
×10	1.3	×50	0.55
×25	0.45	×100	0.15
×50	0.1		
×100	0.05		

Multiplier medals: Simple Treasure draws ×2 to ×4 uniformly, with MEGA ×8 / ×12 / ×20 at 2.0% / 0.8% / 0.2%. Incredible Treasure draws ×3 to ×6, with MEGA ×15 / ×25 / ×40 at 3.0% / 1.2% / 0.3%. Mega Start forces one medal to a MEGA value and reveals 4 Incredible coins before the first shot.

Special shot	Simple Treasure	Incredible Treasure / Mega Start
Golden ball: + to each coin (× bet)	+0.5 (46%) · +1 (30%) · +2 (15%) · +5 (7%) · +10 (2%)	+2 (54%) · +5 (31%) · +10 (13%) · +25 (2%)
Chain shot: + to the raft multiplier	+1 (85%) · +2 (15%)	+1 (65%) · +2 (28%) · +3 (7%)

4.4 RTP Breakdown

Component	Base game	Scatter Boost (per 1.25 bet)
Ways wins	53.26%	42.07%
Powder keg pays	0.89%	1.13%
Simple Treasure	34.62%	42.35%
Incredible Treasure	7.03%	10.13%
Mega Start	0.19%	0.32%
Total	**95.99%**	**96.00%**

4.5 Bonus Statistics

	Simple Treasure	Incredible Treasure	Mega Start
Average win (× bet)	95.91	480.54	784.72
Median	46.5	223	324
90th percentile	221	1147	1998
99th percentile	753.5	3760	6310
Grand Slam rate	2.38%	2.38%	2.43%
Average shots	19.7	19.7	17.4

4.6 Verification

- Line and keg wins are computed exactly over every reel position. Bonus averages, special shots included, come from 2 million simulations per bonus type on the same engine as the game. A full-game simulation of 20 million spins per mode confirms the totals (base 96.15% ± 0.73, Scatter Boost 96.32% ± 0.75).
- Independent check for this document: 1,000,000 bonuses per type (Simple ×95.91 ± 0.32, Incredible ×479.75 ± 1.54, Mega Start ×785.82 ± 2.54), all consistent with the reference values, plus 20,000,000 base spins for hit rate and volatility.

5. Audio Design

- **Music** is synthesised live with the Web Audio API: a sea-shanty base loop (accordion, fiddle, bass, percussion) and a bonus track built in layers.
- **Adaptive bonus music:** the bonus track gains layers as the board heats up (first coins, first activated raft, first bridge), then fades back to the base loop at the end.
- **Effects:** reel stops, keg chimes rising in pitch with each keg, tease heartbeat, sabre drawn and sheathed, parrot squawk, cannon shot, splash, coin pick-ups, multiplier activation, bridge, Grand Slam, big-win fanfare.
- **Captain voice:** seven pirate exclamations (Arrr, Aaargh, Yarr, Yo-ho-ho, Har har, Ahoy, Ho ho ho) and a sobbing cry, made by formant synthesis (a sawtooth voice through three vowel filters, with a rolled R); never the same exclamation twice in a row.
- Separate music and effects volume sliders, mute button, and music that waits for the first tap or click, as browsers require.

6. Technical Specifications

- One HTML file plus the site's shared scripts (languages, live counter): Canvas 2D rendering, Web Audio, vanilla JavaScript, no external images; every symbol, character and scene is drawn in code.
- Logical stage of 1600×900 in landscape and 900×1600–1950 in portrait, scaled to the screen; HUD integrated into the scene.
- RNG: crypto.getRandomValues. The math engine is a single isolated module (strips, ways evaluation, bonus generation, resolution) that can move server-side unchanged.
- French and English interface; play-money balance shared with the other portfolio games.

7. Commercial Roadmap

- RGS integration with server-side outcome generation and a certified RNG.
- Math certification (GLI-19 / BMM) of the base game, bonuses, Scatter Boost and buys.
- RTP variants (for example 94% and 92%) by scaling the paytable and coin tables, for operators and jurisdictions that require them.
- Jurisdiction profiles: switch off bonus buy, autoplay, turbo and slam stop where regulation requires it (for example the UKGC online slot design rules).
- Operator skins and additional languages (DE, ES, PT, IT, SV).